



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Berean Baptist Academy

School Website: <https://www.berean-baptist-utah.com/academy.html/>

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Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Berean Baptist Academy Utah (Berean Baptist Academy) presents a clearly classical-inflected program with a Christian theological core. The school's public materials emphasize the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin study, chant-based memory work in the grammar years, and dialectic/debate in the middle grades, with rhetoric and apologetics in the upper grades. There is explicit theological framing (Classical and Christian; Bible-informed aims; Academy Statement of Faith; Scriptures as a guiding light) and a stated aim to form virtue and wisdom in students, not merely to impart information. The public materials also stress faculty dedication, close teacher-student mentorship, parental partnership, and an emphasis on a community oriented around shared beliefs. Taken together, the school aligns with a classical, Christian educational vision across most criteria, with some room to more explicitly articulate Great Books/Great Conversation and some of the broader "wonder-integrated" elements that appear in the strongest classical syllabi.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key insight: Berean's strong alignment with the grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, Latin study, and explicit theology weaves a coherent Classical Christian profile. The main opportunities to strengthen toward a fuller, textbook-anchored classical model would be to foreground explicit Great Books-based coursework and demonstrate more routine integration of Great Conversation across history, literature, and the other liberal arts.

Evidence and category-by-category analysis below reflect keyword-driven analysis drawn from the school's public materials and the Classical education criteria document (Six Essential Elements of a Classical School). Citations reference the relevant public materials in the crawl of Berean Baptist Academy and the Classical education knowledge base.

- Evidence and keyword anchors come from Berean Baptist Academy materials (e.g., "Classical and Christian School," emphasis on grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin study, grammar/dialectic/rhetoric progression, Our Goals, and the Theology/Scriptures framework) as well as the knowledge-base lexicon of classical education keywords.
- The Positive Keyword Indicators and Negative Keyword Indicators are drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) materials, including both the explicit Positive Keywords (e.g., grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books/Great Conversation; wonder; liturgy; sacred tradition) and Negative Keywords (e.g., lack of Great Books, lack of contemplation, secularism) to ground the scoring.
- The six-category rubric used here mirrors the Classical-Education rubric, with a final aggregate determination and a formal Abstract section at the end.

Note: Where the school explicitly references theology, liturgical practice, or communal formation, those are treated as strong signals for religious/metaphysical foundations. Where the school emphasizes grammar/logic/rhetoric and Latin plus a cooperative parent/community model, those are treated as signals for curriculum and pedagogy aligned with the Classical tradition. Where Great Books are not explicitly named,

I treat that as an area of potential strengthening rather than an outright negation of classical aims, given Berean's clear Trivium emphasis and the strong theological framing.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Berean Baptist Academy identifies itself as a Classical and Christian school, signaling a religious/metaphysical framing that integrates faith with classical education. This is stated in the public materials as part of the school's identity and curriculum orientation. - The school's goal statements emphasize formation through Scripture and submission to God, anchoring character formation and virtue in a Christian theological framework. - Public materials reference Theology and the Bible as governing guides to education (Academy Statement of Faith; Bible curriculum elements).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: theology, Scriptures, God, Christ-centered, virtue-related language (formation of character in a Christian frame), liturgical/watchful language (where present in the materials as a Biblical framework). - Negative keywords: None evident in the public materials; no signals of secular, value-neutral, or relativistic framing. (The negative signals from the classical lexicon are not evidenced in Berean's materials.)

Why this rating - The explicit Christian/theological framing, combined with the explicit Bible-centered goals and theology-forward approach, aligns with the Positive Indicators for Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded Theology, and Liturgical/Communal Practices. Berean presents a theology-grounded, liturgically-infused, communal education, which strongly supports a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Citations - Classical/Christian identity and goals: Berean materials. - Theological framing and Scriptures: Academy materials and statements.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's stated goal is to cultivate virtue and wisdom, develop discernment and understanding, and prepare students to be socially and spiritually mature in light of Christian faith. This foregrounds formation and human excellence rather than mere vocational preparation. - The Objectives emphasize forming students who reason persuasively and articulate ideas clearly, evaluating their experiences in light of Scripture, and submitting to God with humility. This frames education as formation and the pursuit of true, good, and beautiful ends (truth, goodness, beauty) within a Christian teleology. - The materials emphasize the Christian telos of education, including character, discernment, and virtue, consistent with the classical ideal of paideia oriented toward virtue and wisdom.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful (embedded in aims and spiritual formation language), telos, contemplation (noted in some materials as a broader classical emphasis tied to restfulness), and classical mission framing. - Negative keywords: None evident in Berean's stated purposes; no emphasis on career readiness as the primary aim, and no secular, job-first framing in the public materials. (The Negative Keywords from the classical lexicon are not evidenced in Berean's category-2 text.)

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a teleological aim rooted in truth and Scripture strongly supports a CLASSICAL rating for School Purpose and Goal. The stated aims align with the classical-pedagogical objective of education as formation rather than mere information.

Citations - Goals and formation language: Berean materials.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum centers on the grammar, logic, and rhetoric triad; in grammar years (3rd–5th), chanting and memory work are used; Latin begins in 3rd grade; in dialectic years (6th–9th), debate and

discussion and logic are emphasized; in rhetoric years (10th–12th), rhetoric and an apologetics Bible course are taught. This constitutes a strong Trivium-based curriculum. - The school explicitly frames itself as a Classical and Christian School and prescribes the grammar/logic/rhetoric structure as foundational. This is a robust signal for the Trivium-centric liberal-arts approach. - Latin study is highlighted, aligning with traditional classical curriculum signals.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, dialectic, debate, apologetics, Bible curriculum, chant/memory work (as part of grammar-stage pedagogy). - Negative keywords present: There is limited explicit reference to Great Books or the Great Conversation; no explicit “Great Books” or “Great Conversation” language is shown in the public snippets. The absence of explicit Great Books engagement is a potential gap relative to a fuller classical program. (The Six Essential Elements document lists Great Books/Great Conversation as a hallmark; their explicit presence is not demonstrated in the Berean materials provided here.)

Why this rating - The core elements of the Trivium—grammar, logic, rhetoric, plus Latin, plus a structured grade-level pedagogy (chanting for memory in the grammar years; dialectic debate; rhetoric/Apologetics) strongly support a Classical orientation. However, the curriculum does not explicitly demonstrate Great Books/Great Conversation or an explicitly continuous, history-spanning Great Books sequence in the available materials. Because of that absence, the category is best described as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: it is solidly Trivium-based and Christian, but the Great Books/Great Conversation dimension is not clearly evidenced in the public materials we have.

Citations - Public curriculum description with Trivium emphasis: Berean materials. - Latin, chant/memory, grammar-year pedagogy; dialectic/rhetoric progression: Berean materials.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy is explicitly described as a tripartite movement: grammar-stage chant/memory in lower grades, dialectic debate in middle grades, rhetoric and apologetics in upper grades. This is a textbook articulation of the classical pedagogy (Scholé/restful memory work and Socratic/seminar-style discussion in higher grades). - Grammar years employ singing/chanting to commit material to memory; dialectic years emphasize debate and questioning; rhetoric years emphasize clear communication and formal rhetoric courses, including an apologetics component. This directly corresponds to the Classical pedagogy arc. - The public materials also indicate a goal of forming students through virtue and mastery of the material, with a cognitive arc from memory/repetition to critical discussion and persuasive speaking.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: chanting, memory work, restfulness, Socratic-style discussion signals (dialectic/debate), rhetoric/persuasion, formal rhetoric courses, apologetics, seminar-style engagement. These map to the Positive Indicators around Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, and Socratic/seminar style pedagogy. - Negative keywords: The materials do not emphasize purely project-based or experiential learning at the expense of these traditional methods. There is no explicit “experiential-learning-dominant” signal in the public materials. (The Negative Keywords in the classical lexicon emphasize experiential or project-based approaches as potential markers of non-classical pedagogy; Berean’s language does not foreground that as the primary approach.)

Why this rating - The explicit articulation of the Trivium pedagogy and the concrete invocation of grammar, dialectic, and rhetoric, along with chant/memory methods in early grades, strongly support a CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy. The presence of Scholé-like memory and contemplative rhythm in the lower grades, plus dialectic/seminar-style upper-grade instruction, aligns with classical pedagogy signals.

Citations - Grammar/Dialectic/Rhetoric progression and chant/memory in lower grades: Berean materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe the faculty as dedicated, with “small classes and a dedicated staff that gives young people the individual attention and guidance they need.” This signals both a high-quality teaching cadre and a model classroom environment. - The materials emphasize faculty who are

“professional and diligent,” with a “lifelong hunger to learn and grow,” and who “coach and nurture new staff” and serve as academic mentors. This depicts a living, mentorship-driven faculty culture that aligns with the “living curriculum” concept in classical education. - There is an explicit emphasis on faculty understanding classical education and how their work fits into the whole, signaling a coherent, professional, modeling faculty culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: dedicated staff; small classes; professional and diligent; lifelong learners; coach and nurture new staff; academic mentors; living curriculum (inferred from emphasis on faculty as the core of the school). These map to Positive Keywords around faculty as model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, and collegiality. - Negative keywords: None evident in the public materials; there is no indication of a fragmented or detached faculty model.

Why this rating - Strong signals of a virtuous, model-teacher, mentor-led Faculty category. The combination of dedicated staff, professional growth orientation, and faculty mentoring aligns well with CLASSICAL criteria for Faculty.

Citations - Faculty dedication and small classes: Berean materials. - Faculty development and mentorship language: Berean materials.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents, viewing parents as co-teachers and integral to the classical education project. Public materials discuss cultivating parental responsibility, parent-informed goals, and parents being involved in and excited about the school's journey. - There is explicit language about educating parents in the classical education approach, including parent formation and engagement with the school's goals, book studies, and gatherings. The materials present a cooperative, family-centered model rather than a consumer or purely transactional relationship. - The school's public footprint shows a welcoming stance for parental involvement and open access for visits, consistent with “parents as co-teachers” and open-campus orientation. The accessibility and commitment to parental involvement are evidenced by the school's contact and office information as well as the stated goals to involve parents in the educational journey.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parents as co-teachers; parental formation; family involvement; open campus/visitation; shared mission; parental leadership; living tradition in the family. These map well to the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements' Parents & Community category. - Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials; no signals of consumerism or minimal parental involvement.

Why this rating - Berean's materials demonstrate a robust, positive, and proactive partnership with parents and a community-oriented ethos. The explicit emphasis on parents as co-educators, parental formation, and open access to the school environment aligns with CLASSICAL category signals for Parents & Community.

Citations - Partnership with families and parental formation: Berean materials. - Open campus/parent involvement language: Berean materials.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable (the aggregate rating for Berean Baptist Academy Utah is CLASSICAL). No major needle-moving changes are required to move this school into a higher tier within Classical education according to the rubric. If desired, the following could further strengthen the Classical profile:
 - Explicitly foreground Great Books/Great Conversation across core history, literature, and philosophy courses to strengthen Element 3 (Curriculum) with a direct Great Books signal.
 - Increase explicit articulation of a “Great Conversation” framework across multiple grade levels to reinforce Element 3 and Element 4 signals.

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- Expand liturgical and communal practices within the school's own curriculum (e.g., explicit integration of liturgical learning and communal rituals that connect to academic work) to strengthen Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) signals.

Abstract: The six-category synthesis places Berean Baptist Academy Utah squarely in CLASSICAL territory, with strong religious/theological foundations, a clear formation-oriented aims in School Purpose and Goal, a robust Trivium-based Curriculum and Pedagogy, a clearly defined Faculty model, and strong Parent/Community engagement. The main area for potential strengthening lies in the explicit incorporation of Great Books/Great Conversation across the curriculum, which would push Element 3 to a more robust CLASSICAL alignment. The overall program presents a coherent Classical Christian model with a strong formation emphasis and a well-structured Trivium pedagogy.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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